Who pays for the grid?

A 30-year estimate of data-center transmission payments under AND pricing

A / ADDITIONAL PAYMENTS

Conditional additional payments

$75bn

Above the embedded-price baseline; matched by lower bills for other customers.

B / ABOVE INCREMENTAL COST

Total inherited-grid contribution

$149bn

Above incremental transmission cost; includes payments already made under the baseline.

2027-2056, constant 2026 dollars, undiscounted. In this central case, A is part of B; do not add them. B excludes modeled incremental transmission cost; it is not an overcharge above fully allocated cost of service.

Low / Medium / High demand paths

U.S. facility TWh/year	Low	Medium	High
2030 (EPRI)	383	596	793
2035 (extrapolated)	433	752	1,288
2056 (extrapolated)	500	1,096	2,505

After 2030, transfer IEA global scenario growth rates through 2035; taper to selected 0.5% / 1.5% / 2.5% annual growth by 2040, then hold to 2056. These are our U.S. extrapolations, not published long-run forecasts. Medium is the default.

Central: $0.65m/MW capital; $95.1/kW-year NITS proxy; 80% load factor.

A comparable policy scale

About 2.4 times the ITC illustration. JCT officially scored BBB's transmission ITC at **$11.279bn over FY2022-2031**. For a common 30-year comparison, we normalize its annual cash flows to 2026 dollars at an assumed 2.5% inflation rate and repeat that real ten-year profile three times: **$31.7bn**. This is our repeated-program illustration, not an official 30-year score or the 30-year benefit of a single ten-year credit. BAAJA transfers private bills; the ITC costs the federal budget and does not guarantee equivalent bill savings.

Mechanism and limits. AND collects the full annual cost of attributable upgrades plus a contribution to the inherited grid. Incremental receipts are credited out of the shared revenue requirement. Fixed: 75% modeled-grid participation; an 829 GW planning-peak proxy for the incumbent pool; charges from 2030, including prospective charges on 2027-2029 entrants; 40-year assets, 5% real financing and 1.5% O&M. Other demand excluded from costs and billing. No prior-payment offset. Growth, cost, coverage and national pooling are assumptions. PUDL v2026.10.0 was reviewed; it does not establish a matched national NITS rate or DC-attributable capital per MW.

Sources: EPRI Powering Intelligence 2026, Figure5; IEA Key Questions on Energy and AI, TableA.1; BAAJA draft s.2107(a); JCT JCX-46-21 p.2; EIA AEO2026 Table54; Grid Strategies Nov2025 p.33. Full source links and calculations accompany the dashboard.